

Book 1

RHYTHM
STYLE



Part 5

RHYTHM # 8

COUNTRY STYLE

RHYTHMS



COUNTRY STYLE RHYTHMS

The 3 easiest rhythms to use for country songs are:

- OOM PAH
- LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD
- 12/8 COUNTRY SHUFFLE

You learned OOM PAH in Rhythm #4.

And you just learned the Left Note / Right Split Chord.

The 12/8 Country Shuffle is going to be a MIX of these two rhythms.

but before you get into it let's play a few country songs using OOM PAH and LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD.



COUNTRY STYLE

OOM PAH & LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD

RHYTHM: Country Oom Pah (In the style of... Jambalaya - *Hank Williams*)



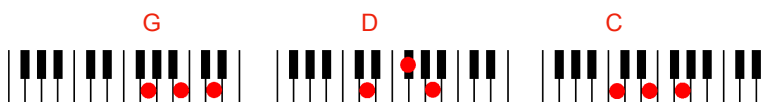
C	C	G	G	G	G	C	C
C	C	G	G	G	G	C	C

RHYTHM: Country Oom Pah (In the style of... You Are My Sunshine - *Johnny Cash*)



C	C	C	C	F	F	C	C
F	F	C	C	C	G	C	C

RHYTHM: LN/RC Split (In the style of... You Say Nothing At All - *Notting Hill*)



LN/RC Split

G	D	C	D	<i>Repeat x 4</i>
---	---	---	---	-------------------

Half Beat Bounce

C	D	G	D/F#	C/E	D	<i>and so on</i>
---	---	---	------	-----	---	------------------

RHYTHM: LN/RC Split (In the style of... Remember When - *Alan Jackson*)



Remember..	G	Em7	Cadd2	D	<i>repeat</i>
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12/8 COUNTRY SHUFFLE

This rhythm is a cross between a SPLIT CHORD rhythm (RIGHT hand).
and an OOM-PAH rhythm (LEFT hand).

The rhythm is played in what is called '12/8' time. This means there are 4
groups of 3 beats (12 fast beats per bar).

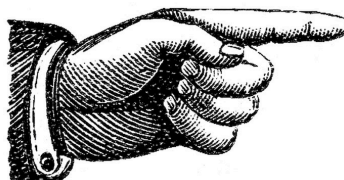
To get the shuffle rhythm you only play on the 1st and 3rd of each group of 3
notes. Tap out the following rhythm as you count out the 4 groups of 3 beats.

TAP	•		•	•		•	•		•	•		•
COUNT	1	2	3	1	2	3	1	2	3	1	2	3

Notice how it 'SHUFFLES' along.

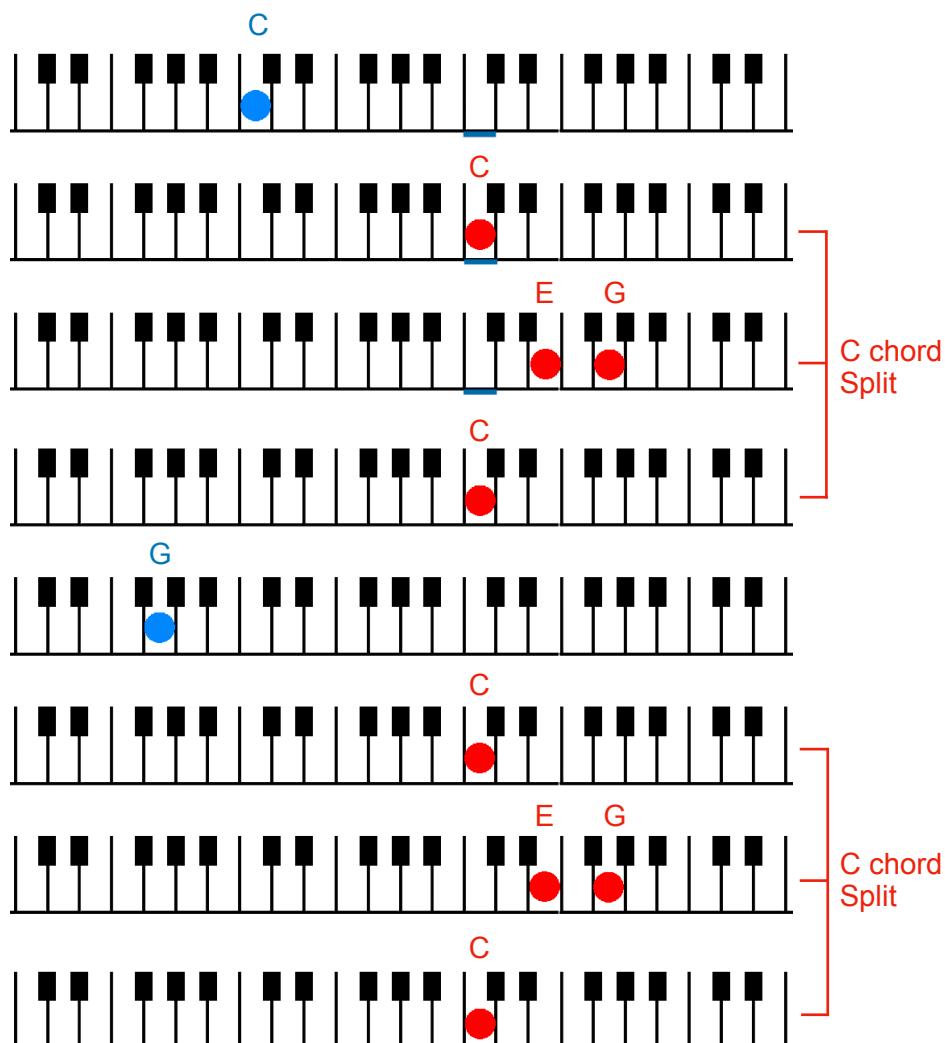
What you are going to do is play this SAME shuffle rhythm using a combination
of two left hand notes and a right hand chord split between thumb and (3rd
and 5th fingers).

Let's try the rhythm with the chord of C.



12/8 COUNTRY SHUFFLE

Find the notes for the rhythm for the chord of C.



← PEDAL over each bar →

C	C CHORD SPLIT	C CHORD SPLIT	C CHORD SPLIT
----------	------------------	------------------	------------------

The musical notation shows a 12/8 time signature. The treble clef staff contains a sequence of eighth notes and rests. Below the treble staff, the rhythm is indicated by the numbers 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3. The bass clef staff contains a sequence of eighth notes and rests. Below the bass staff, the notes C, G, C, and G are indicated for each bar. A green double-headed arrow above the notation spans the first two bars and is labeled 'PEDAL over each bar'.

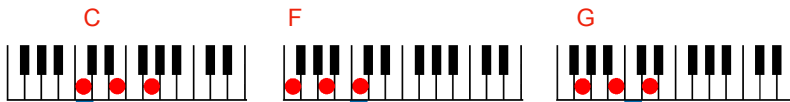
TRANSCOPE the rhythm to the chords of F and G and you have the makings of lots of great country songs.

COUNTRY STYLE

12/8 COUNTRY SHUFFLE

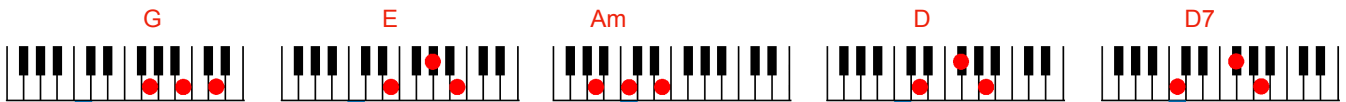
1-239

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... King Of The Road - *Roger Miller*)



C	F	G	C	C	F	G	G
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... Crazy - *Patsy Cline*)



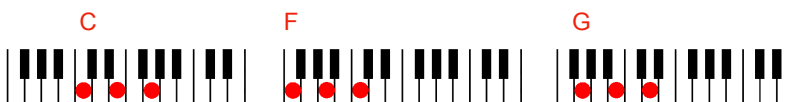
G	E	Am	Am	D	D7	G	D
G	E	Am	Am	D	D7	G	G7

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... Behind Closed Doors - *Charlie Rich*)



C	F G	C	C	C	F	G	G
C	F G	C	C	C Dm	F G	C	C

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... Your Cheatin' Heart - *Patsy Cline*)



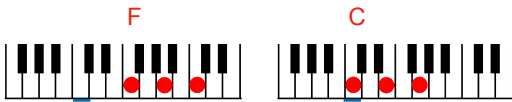
C	C	F	F	G	G	C	C
C	C	F	F	G	G	C	C

COUNTRY STYLE

12/8 COUNTRY SHUFFLE

1-240

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... Blue Eyes Cryin In The Rain - *Willie Nelson*)



F	F	F	F	C	C	F	F	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---------------

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... Blue Eyes Cryin In The Rain - *Willie Nelson*) in D



D	D	D	D	A	A	D	D	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---------------

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... He Stopped Lovin' Her Today - *George Jones*)



D	D	G	G	A	A7	D	D	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	---	---	---	----	---	---	---------------

RHYTHM: 12/8 Country Shuffle (In the style of... He Stopped Lovin' Her Today - *George Jones*)



C	C	F	F	G	G7	C	C	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	---	---	---	----	---	---	---------------

COUNT

LEFT HAND

RIGHT HAND

1

and

2

and

3

and

4

and

The diagram illustrates a sequence of piano keyboard exercises. It is organized into four pairs of exercises, each preceded by a count (1, 2, 3, 4) and the word 'and'. Each exercise consists of a left hand part and a right hand part. The left hand parts are marked with blue circles and numbers, and the right hand parts are marked with red circles and numbers. The exercises involve playing specific notes (C, D, E, G) and fingerings (1, 2, 3, 5) on a piano keyboard.

Exercise 1: Left hand plays C (finger 1). Right hand plays C (finger 1).

Exercise 2: Left hand plays C (finger 5). Right hand plays D (finger 2), E (finger 3), and G (finger 5).

Exercise 3: Left hand plays C (finger 5). Right hand plays C (finger 1).

Exercise 4: Left hand plays C (finger 5). Right hand plays D (finger 2), E (finger 3), and G (finger 5).

Exercise 5: Left hand plays C (finger 5). Right hand plays C (finger 1).

The first system of the musical score is in 4/4 time. The treble clef staff contains a melody of eighth notes: G4 (quarter rest), A4, B4, A4, G4 (quarter rest), A4, B4, A4, G4 (quarter rest), A4, B4, A4, G4. The bass clef staff contains a bass line of half notes: C3, G2, C3, G2. The notes C and G are labeled in red below the staff.

COUNTRY STYLE

'add2' the Country NOTE!

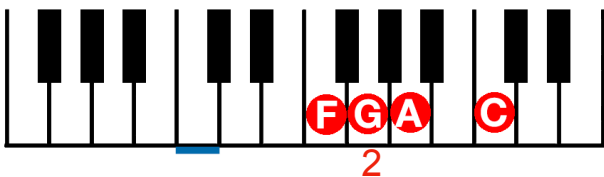
1-242

So you can add the '2' note (add2) to ANY of your chords.

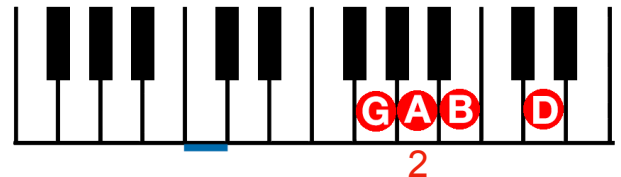
But don't overdo it - use it on one or two main chords, and leave it out for other chords, so you get a balance with the overall sound.

Lets see what the 'add2' looks like with some of the chords you know .

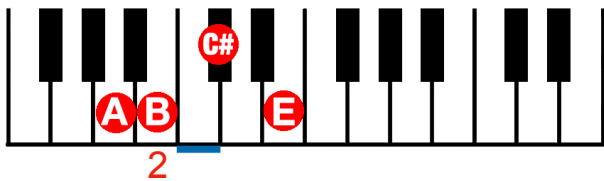
F add2



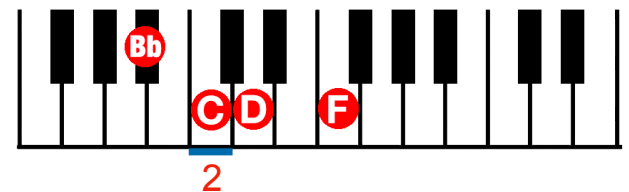
G add2



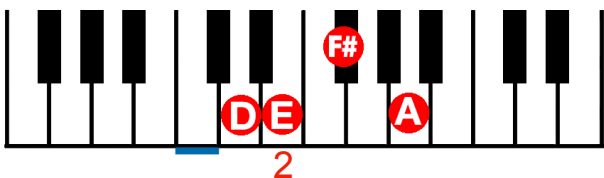
A add2



Bb add2



D add2



BONUS COUNTRY RHYTHM

HOME ON THE RANGE

1-243

I couldn't leave Country Style Rhythms until we had learned the ultimate cowboy song - 'Home On The Range' - sometimes called the 'unofficial anthem' of the American West. The singer 'Roy Rodgers' is often associated with the song.

Check out this great Wikipedia article on the song.

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Home_on_the_Range

The song is in 3/4 time (3 beats to the bar).

You are going to play a rhythm with a similar feel to the 12/8 country shuffle (with an Oom Pah left hand and a split chord right hand) but change it to a 3/4 rhythm.

Lets try it with a C chord over 2 bars.

COUNT

1

2

3

1

2

3

C chord split

C chord split

C chord split

C chord split

C

G

5

C **F** **Fm**

Oh give me a home where the bu-----ff-----alo roam, and the

(root) (5th) (root) Ab

C **D** **G**

deer and the an-----te-----lope play.

(root) (root) (root)

C G7 C
Home, home on the range,
C D7 G7
Where the deer and the antelope play.
C F (Fm)
Where seldom is heard a discouraging word,
C G7 C
And the skies are not cloudy all day.



LESSONS CHECKPOINT



1-245

- ☐ Do you understand how to play the SPLIT CHORD rhythm ?
- ☐ Do you use the pedal with the Split Chord Rhythm?
- ☐ What are the two variations of the Split Chord Rhythm?
- ☐ Were you able to play the practice progressions?
- ☐ What is the difference between the Split Chord rhythm and the Left Note / Right Split Chord rhythm?
- ☐ What is the difference between the Left Note / Right Split Chord rhythm and the 12/8 Country Shuffle rhythm?
- ☐ What 'extra' note is added to the 12/8 country shuffle to give an authentic country sound?
- ☐ Can you play all the Greensleeves patterns? How many different patterns are there? Do you see how they are all based on rhythms you have learned already?
- ☐ Can you play them from memory?
- ☐ Which Greensleeves pattern do you find easier and which do you find more difficult? Practice the more difficult patterns daily.
- ☐ Did you try the pattern with the melody in the right hand? You can read the music or work it out by ear. The more you practice it, the easier it will become.

At this point ask yourself if you are taking enough TIME going through the course. Do you feel that you can play everything up to this point? If you know that there are many parts that you struggle with then you need to go BACK and practice with those exercises until you can play them reasonably well.

RHYTHM # 9

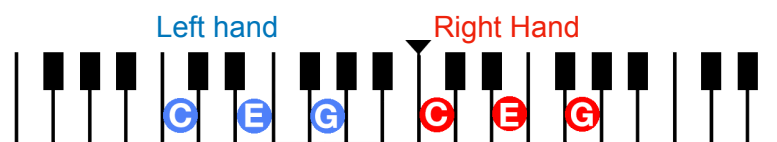
TWIST RHYTHM



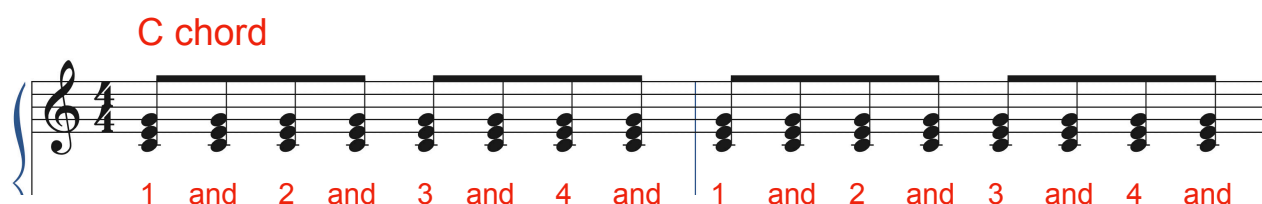
TWIST RHYTHM

This rhythm uses a 3-note pattern in the LEFT hand, but **DON'T PANIC**, the 3 LEFT hand notes always **MATCH** the 3 notes of the RIGHT hand.

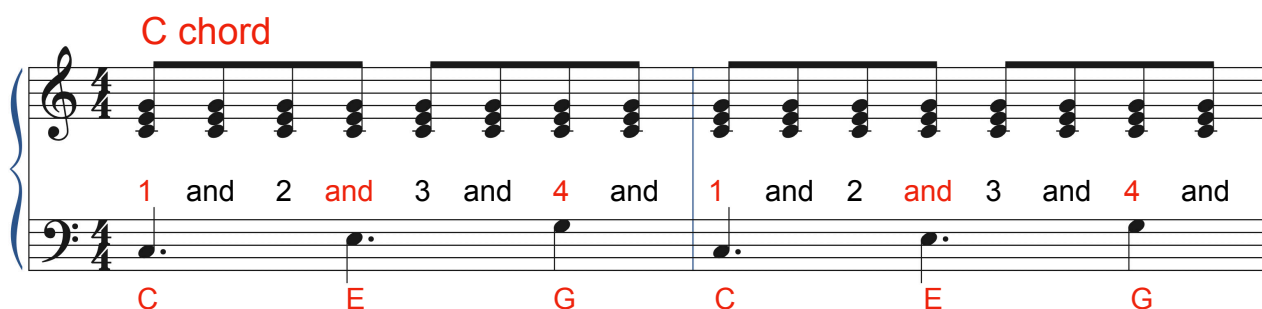
Locate these LEFT and RIGHT hand C CHORDS.



Now beat out **EIGHT** fast 1/2 BEATS per bar with the RIGHT hand.



Now add the LEFT hand notes on these beats.



You DON'T use the PEDAL

To help you know when to bring in the LEFT hand notes 'say' the BEATS out loud where the left hand notes come in.

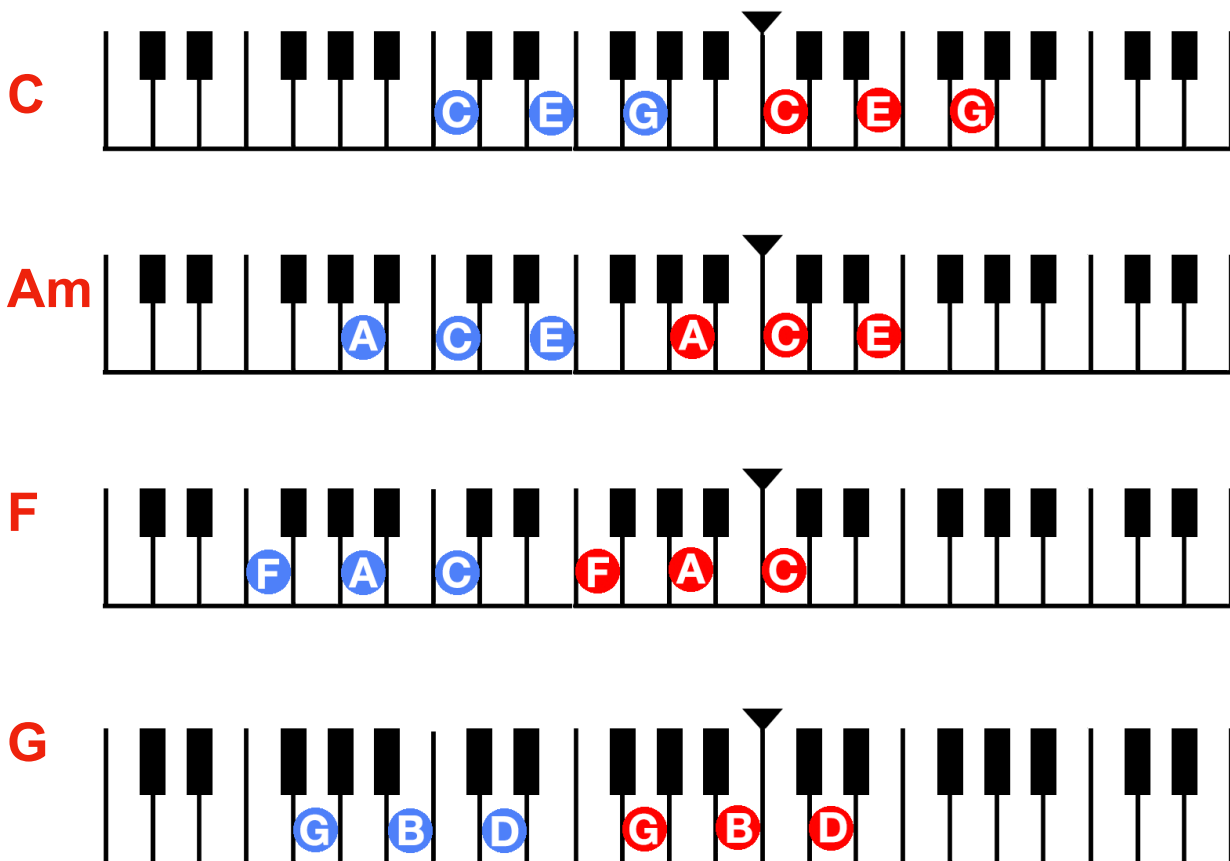
ie "**ONE** and two **AND** three and **FOUR** and **ONE** and two **AND** three and **FOUR** and"

It is also good practice to tap this rhythm out with both hands on the table - this way you'll get used to it as PURE rhythm and the notes won't distract you.

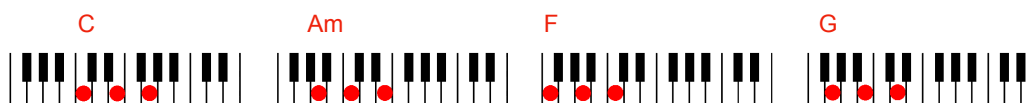
Now let's play a familiar song using this rhythm

A TYPICAL PROGRESSION

Transpose the rhythm you just learned using the chord of C to the chords of Am, F and G and then play the progression in the style of LET'S TWIST AGAIN (See how many songs use this chord progression!)



RHYTHM: Twist (Let's Twist Again - Chubby Checker)



C	C	Am	Am	F	F	G	G
---	---	----	----	---	---	---	---

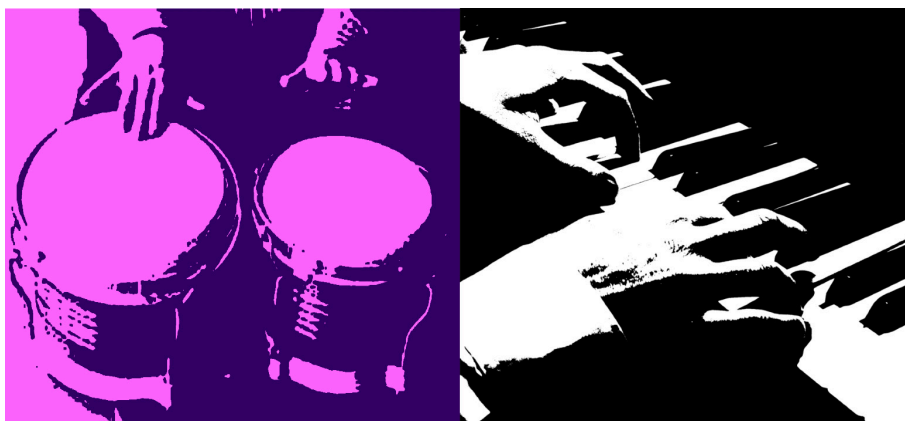
NOTE - In section 3 you will learn how to play your right hand chords in different combinations - these are called 'Inversions'.

For those of you that already play some inversions - it is important to remember that when you play inversions for the TWIST rhythm you ALWAYS play the LEFT HAND chord pattern in ROOT POSITION - only the Right Hand plays the inversion.

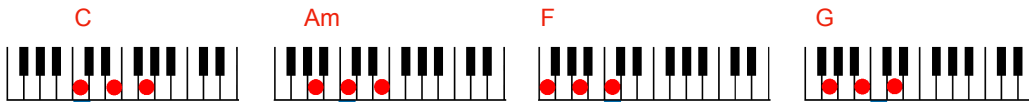
TWIST RHYTHM

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS / D, E, A, B $\flat$



RHYTHM: Twist (In the style of... Stand By Me - Ben E. King)



C	C	Am	Am	F	G	C	C
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RHYTHM: Twist (In the style of... Under The Boardwalk - The Drifters)



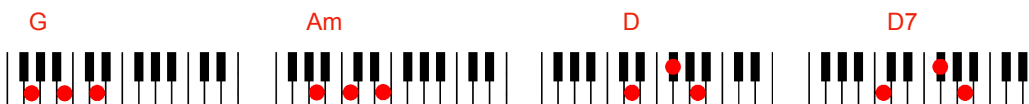
G	G	D	D7	D	D	G	G
C	C	G	G	G	D	G	G

RHYTHM: Twist (In the style of... Barbara Anne - The Beach Boys)



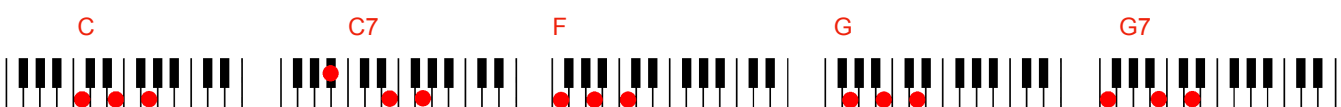
C	C	F	F	C	C	G	F	C	C
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

RHYTHM: Twist (In the style of... Only The Lonely - Roy Orbison)



G	G	G	Am	Am	D	D	D7	G	G
---	---	---	----	----	---	---	----	---	---

RHYTHM: Twist (In the style of... The Ballad Of John And Yoko - John Lennon)



C	C	C	C	C7	C7
C7	C7	F	F	C	C
G	G7	C	C		



STUDENT Q & A

Q - When I play the Twist rhythm my wrists and arms become tired or sore - what can I do about that?



A - Don't worry this is a common problem for beginners.

You are making your muscles do exercises they aren't used to doing.

Its like going to the gym - you just need to build up slowly.

Don't overdo it - stop when you feel strain - stretch and massage your wrists.

Just practice these rhythms briefly for a few days or weeks. Eventually your muscles will get used to them.

Try to relax AS you play - just be conscious of any tension.

You may be holding your breath or holding your stomach tightly and you may be tightening the arm or wrist muscles through concentration.

If that happens just keep playing but 'let go' of the tension as much as possible.

It helps to SMILE as you relax your shoulders, arms, wrists, fingers. You will play just as well without all the tension :-)

Bringing some life
to your LEFT hand!



'SLASH' chords
and BASS RUNS

SLASH CHORDS

Very often you will see chord symbols written like this.

$$F/G \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{F}{G}$$

Both these indicate that you are to play (in THIS case) an F CHORD in the RIGHT hand and a G NOTE in the left hand (at the SAME time).

$$\text{So} \quad F/G = \text{RH CHORD} / \text{LH NOTE}$$

$$\text{OR} \quad \frac{F}{G} = \frac{\text{RH CHORD}}{\text{LH NOTE}}$$

It helps if you say what it means out loud.

For instance, if you see F/G say..."F OVER G"

(Right Hand being Top of piano and Left Hand the bottom).

So what are they all about?

Very often slash chords indicate that the left hand is going to play a BASS RUN which will lead to the next chord. Imagine you are playing the part of the BASS player.

In section 4 you will learn about more advanced chords which make use of this slash format but for now we will just use them in the context of left hand bass runs.

SLASH CHORDS

Try the following chord sequence based on 'Whiter Shade Of Pale' which uses a 'SLASH CHORD' bass line - The rhythm is **Half Beat Bounce**.

CHORDS USED

C

F

G

PEDAL over each Chord / Bass Note change.

System 1: Chords C, C/B, C/A, C/G. Bass notes: C, C, B, B, A, A, G, G.

System 2: Chords F, F/E, F/D, F/C. Bass notes: F, F, E, E, D, D, C, C.

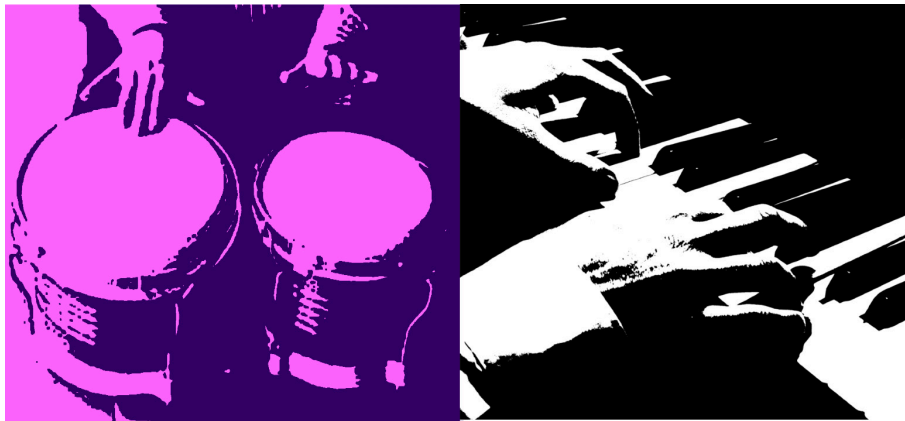
System 3: Chords G, G/F, G/E, G/D. Bass notes: G, G, F, F, E, E, D, D.

System 4: Chords C, F, C, G. Bass notes: C, C, F, F, C, C, G, G.

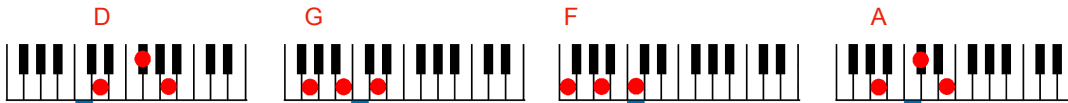
SLASH CHORDS

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS / D, E, A, Bb



RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (Where Did You Sleep Last Night? - Folk song - Leadbelly - Nirvana)



VERY SLOWLY

D D/A G F
My girl, my girl, don't lie to me.
 A A/E D
Tell me where did you sleep last night?
 D D/A
In the pines, in the pines.
 G F
Where the sun don't ever shine,
 A A/E D
I would shiver the whole night through.

[Verse 2]

D D/A G F
My girl, my girl, where will you go?
 A A/E D
I'm goin' where the cold wind blows.
 D D/A
In the pines, in the pines.
 G F
Where the sun don't ever shine,
 A A/E D
I would shiver the whole night through.

Abide With Me

Rather than show chord boxes I have added the red arrows to show whether to play certain chords (or Bass Notes) below mid C (←) or above mid C (→).

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (Abide With Me - in C)

C ← G/B Am C/G ← F ← G C C
 A---bide with me; fast falls the even-tide,
 C Dm → F C/E Dm7 D7 ← G G
 The dark-ness de--epens; Lord, with me a---bide.
 C ← G/B Am C/G ← F A7/E → Dm → Dm/C ←
 When other hel--pers fail and comforts flee,
 ← G ← G/B C ← G/B Am Dm C ← G7 C
 Help of the he---lp----less, a---bide with me.

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (Abide With Me - in G)

← G → D7 → Em → G C D ← G ← G
 A - - bide with me; fast falls the even-tide,
 ← G ← Am C ← G Am7 A7 → D → D
 The dark-ness de--epens; Lord, with me a---bide.
 ← G → D7/F# → Em → G/D C → E7/B ← Am Am/G
 When other hel--pers fail and comforts flee,
 → D → D/F# → G → D/F# Em → Am → G D7 ← G
 Help of the he---lp----less, a---bide with me.

Octaves in bass →

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (the Twelve Days Of Christmas / and a Partridge in a Pear Tree)

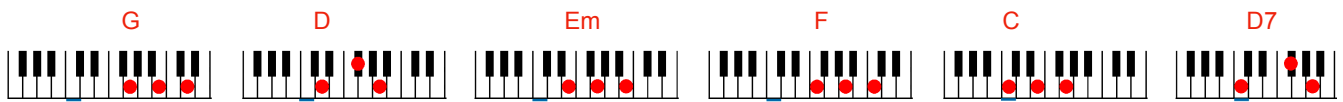


G Em
 On the first day of Christmas,
 Am D G
 My true love sent to me,
 G/B C G/D D G
 A par--tridge in a pear tree.

[Verse]
 G Em
 On the second day of Christmas,
 Am D G
 My true love sent to me,
 D
 Two turtle doves,
 G/B C G/D D G
 A par--tridge in a pear tree.

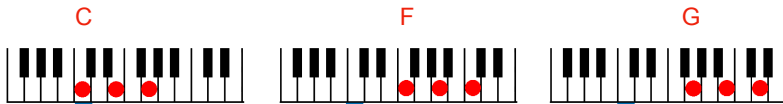
[Verse]
 G Em
 On the third day of Christmas,
 Am D G
 My true love sent to me,
 D
 Three French hens,
 D
 Two turtle doves,
 G/B C G/D D G
 A par--tridge in a pear tree.

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Freebird - Lynyrd Skynyrd)



G	D/F#	Em	Em/D	F	C	D	D7	Repeat
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RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Whiter Shade Of Pale - Procul Harum)



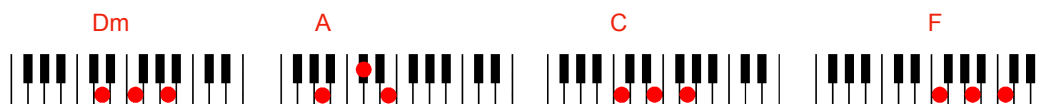
C	C/B	C/A	C/G	F	F/E	F/D	F/C
G	G/F	G/E	G/D	C	F	C	G

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Don't Think Twice It's Alright - Bob Dylan)



G	D/F#	Em	Em/D	C	G	D
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RHYTHM: Straight Beat or Fast Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Sunny Afternoon - The Kinks)



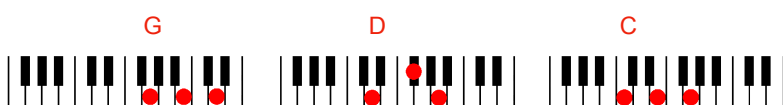
Intro

Dm	Dm/C	Dm/B	Dm/Bb	A	A/G	A/F	A/E
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verse

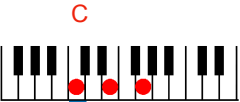
Dm	C	F	C	A	A/G	A/F	A/E	Dm
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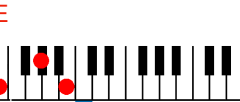
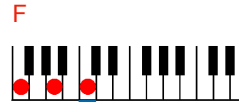
RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... You Look Wonderful Tonight - Eric Clapton)



G	D/F#	C/E	D	Repeat
---	------	-----	---	--------

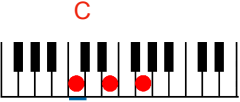
RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Don't Look Back In Anger - Oasis)

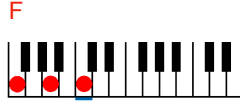
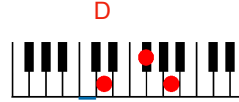


C	G/B	Am	E/G#	F	G	C	Am	G
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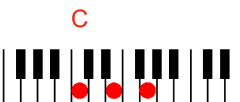
RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Mind Games - John Lennon)



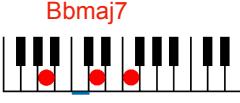
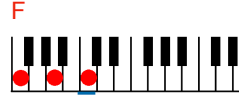
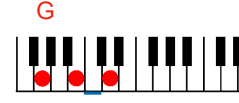




C	G/B	Am	C/G	F	C	D
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce or Split Chord (In the style of... Mandy - Barry Manilow)





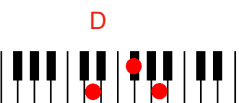
C	Cmaj7	C	Cmaj7	Dm	Dm7	Bbmaj7	F/G	G
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce or Split Chord (In the style of... Hello - Lionel Richie)




Em	Em/D	Em/C	Em/D	Repeat 3 times
Em	Em/D	Em/C	E	

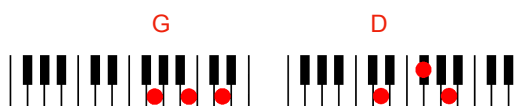
RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Here In Heaven - Eric Clapton)



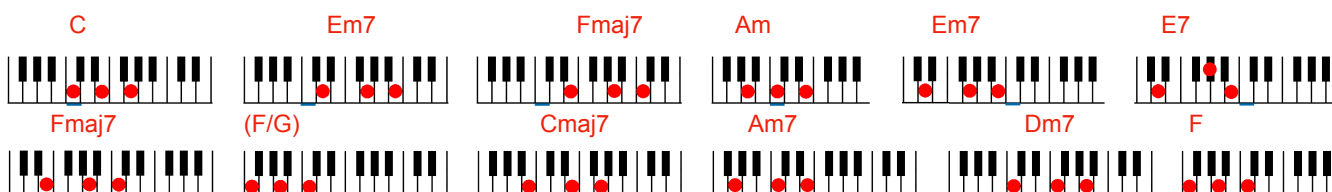

G(1)	D/F#	Em	Em/D	C/E	G(2)/B	D	D	Repeat
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RHYTHM: Left Note / Right Chord (In the style of... My Baby Just Cares For Me - *Nina Simone*)



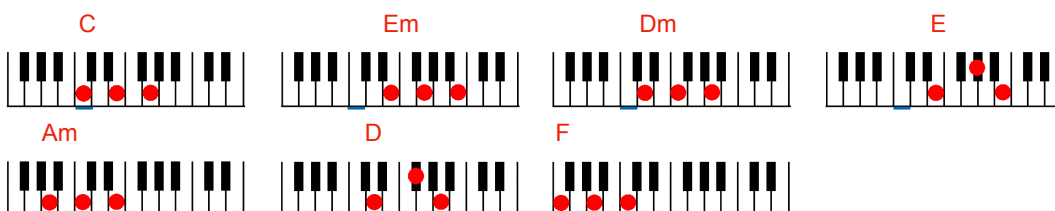
G	G/F#	G/E	G/D	G/C	G/A	G/G	D
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Memories - *Barbara Streisand*)



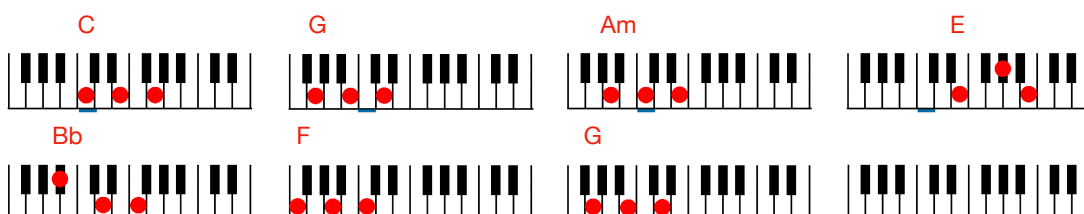
C	Em7	Fmaj7	Am	Am/G	Fmaj7	Em7	E7
Am	Am/G	Fmaj7	F/G	Cmaj7	Am7	Dm7	F/G

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Without You - *Harry Nilsson*)



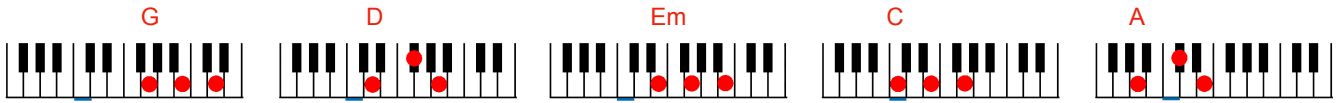
C	Em	Dm	E	Am	Am/G	D	C	F/G
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Nothing Compares To You - *Prince*)



C	G/B	Am	C	G	Repeat x 3
C	G/B	Am	E		
Bb	F	Bb	F	G	

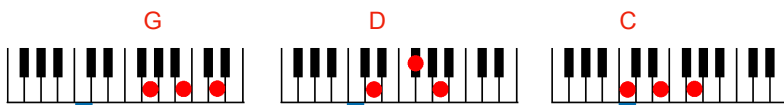
RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Can You Feel The Love Tonight - *CHORUS* - *Lion King*)



Chorus

G	D/F#	Em	C	G	C	A/C#	D
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... We've Got Tonight - *Kenny Rogers*)



G	D/F#	C/E	D/F#	G/B	C	G/D	D
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Wish You Were Here - *Pink Floyd*)



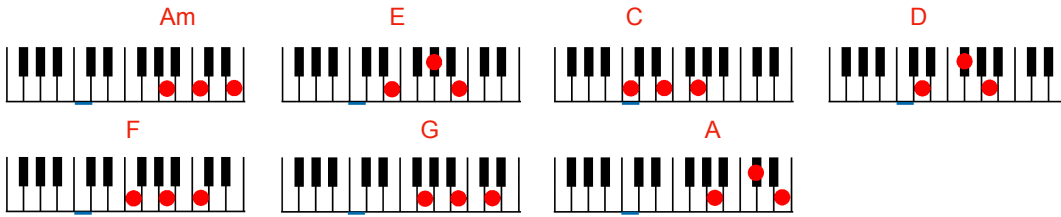
C	D/F#	Am/E	G	D/F#	C/E	Am	G
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... You Raise Me Up - *Josh Groban*) in G



G	C	G	G	G/B	C	C/D	D
Em	C	G	C	G	D	G	

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Let It Grow - *Eric Clapton*)



Am	E/G#	C/G	D/F#	F	G	Am	E/G#
C/G	D/F#	F	G	A			

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce - Slash (In the style of... When A Man Loves A Woman - *Michael Bolton*)



C	G/B	Am	C7/G	F	G7	C	G
---	-----	----	------	---	----	---	---

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce - Slash (In the style of... When A Man Loves A Woman - *Michael Bolton*)



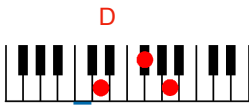
F	C/E	Dm	F7/C	Bb	C7	F	C
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce - Slash (In the style of... When A Man Loves A Woman - *Michael Bolton*)



G	D/F#	Em	G7/D	C	D7	G	D
---	------	----	------	---	----	---	---

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce - Slash (In the style of... Dear Prudence - *The Beatles*) in D



D	D/C	D/B	D/Bb	Repeat x 4
---	-----	-----	------	------------

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce - Slash (In the style of... Dear Prudence - *The Beatles*) in C



C	C/Bb	C/A	C/Ab	Repeat x 4
---	------	-----	------	------------

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... All The Young Dudes - *CHORUS* - David Bowie)



Chorus

D	D/C#	D/B	D/A	Am	Am/G	F	C	G	C	A	D
---	------	-----	-----	----	------	---	---	---	---	---	---

RHYTHM: HBB or Split Chord (In the style of... Our House - Crosby Stills & Nash - *CHORUS*)



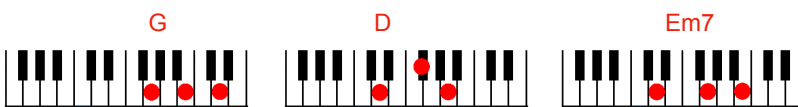
Chorus

G (1)	GM7/F#	Em	G/D	C	G(2)/B	C	G(2)
C	G(2)	C	Am C	Etc			

RHYTHM: Straight Beats (In the style of... Stay - Rihanna)

Chorus & verse 1

C	Dm	Am	Am/G	Am	Am/G	Am	Am/G	Repeat x 4
---	----	----	------	----	------	----	------	------------

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce + (In the style of... All You Need Is Love - Beatles)

G	D/F#	Em7 (riff)	G	D/F#	Em7 (riff)
D/A	G	D/F# G/E	D	D/C	D (riff)

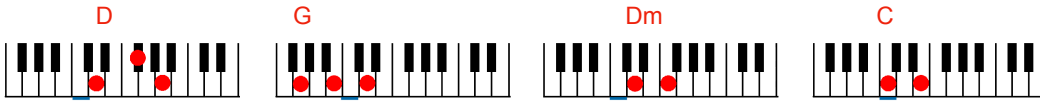
RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Say You Won't Let Go - James Arthur)

G	D/F#	Em	C	Repeat
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RHYTHM: Slow HBB (In the style of... When We Were Young - Adele)

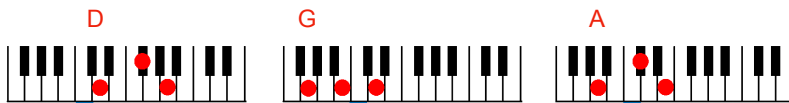
Am	Em	F	C/E	Dm	C	C/B	Repeat
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce + (In the style of... Isolation - *John Lennon*)



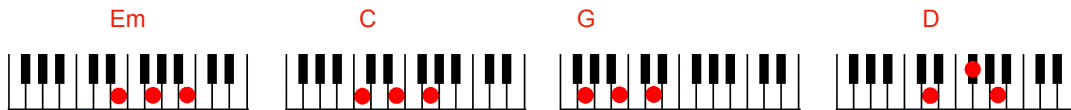
D	D/Bb	D/B	D/C	G	Dm	C	G	D
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RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Thinking Out Loud - *Ed Sheeran*)



D	D/F#	G	A
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RHYTHM: Straight Beat (In the style of... Zombies - *The Cranberries*)



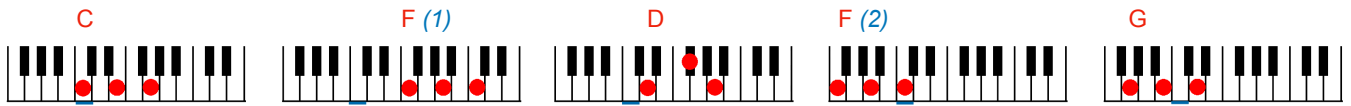
Em	C	G	D/F#
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RHYTHM: HBB / split chord (In the style of... Don't look back in anger - *Oasis*)



C	G/B	Am	E/G#	F	G	C	Am	G
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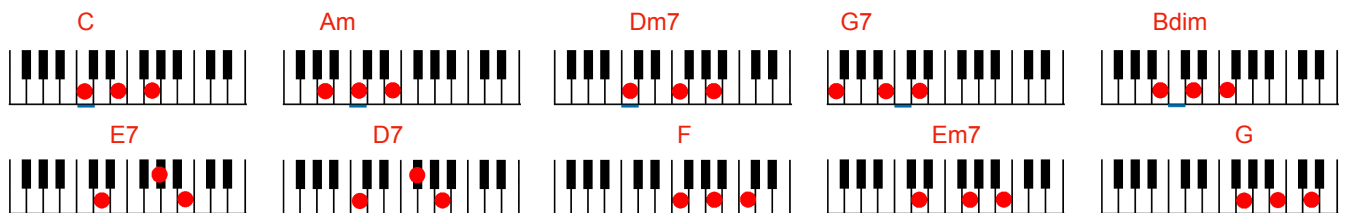
RHYTHM: HBB (In the style of... Don't Let The Sun Go Down On Me - *CHORUS* - George Michael)



CHORUS

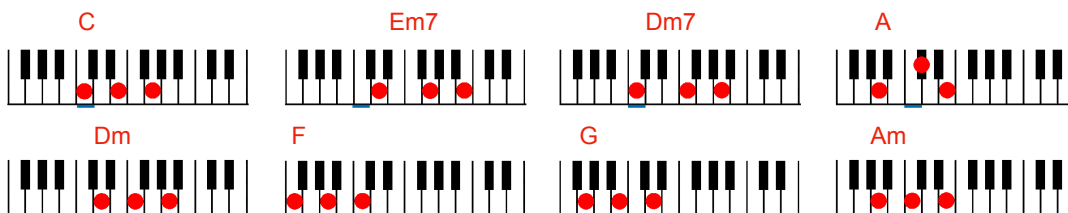
C	C/Bb	F(1)/A	D/F#
C/G	F(2)/G	G	C

RHYTHM: HBB - Slash (In the style of... Don't It Make My Brown Eyes Blue - Crystal Gayle)



C	Am	Dm7	G7	C	Am	Bdim	E7
Am	C/G	D7/F#	D7	F	Em7	F	G

RHYTHM: HBB (In the style of... How Deep Is Your Love - Bee Gees)



C	Em7	Dm7	A	Dm	Dm7	F/G	G
C	Em7	Am		Dm7		F/G	G

RHYTHM # 10

Static Broken Chord



RHYTHM NUMBER 10

STATIC BROKEN CHORD

This rhythm is for very slow songs that have lots of chord changes. It's a nice rhythm that gives an improvised sound without having to move away from the basic chord tones.

I call it 'Static Broken Chord' Rhythm for several reasons.

For the most basic form of this rhythm you simply play each chord ONCE and sing over the top. The left hand bass note is played at the same time.

To bring some life to the rhythm, you BREAK UP the notes of the chord in various ways WITHOUT MOVING AWAY from the position the chord is being played in.

For instance if you are playing a C chord and play C E G in the right hand you keep your hand on the C E G and play with those notes 'under your fingers'.

So you might quickly sweep up from left to right - C then E then G - or you might just play the three notes randomly (under the fingers).

You try to play patterns that fit with the melody of the song and you try to get a good variety between just playing the full chord and broken chord patterns.

The good thing is you don't HAVE to play anything too intricate and to begin with don't try to play the melody because if you start playing the melody you have to KEEP playing it. If you just play with the chord tones it sounds like you are simply playing some nice underlying chord patterns.

Imagine Elvis singing some slow ballad and the guy on the guitar is simply strumming each chord ONCE slowly with maybe a few extra notes added here and there.

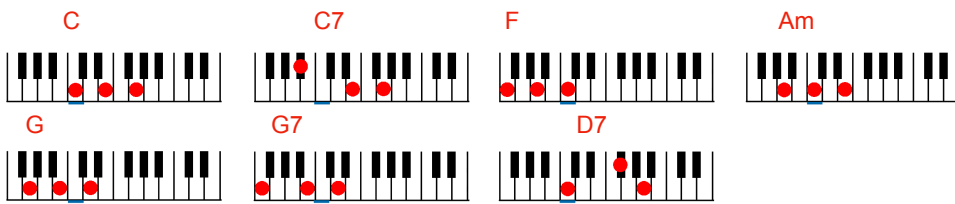
That's the feeling you are going for - simple - deliberate - subtle - discreet.

Watch the video carefully. Have fun :-)



Keep the sustain pedal down over each chord change

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Swing Low Sweet Chariot)



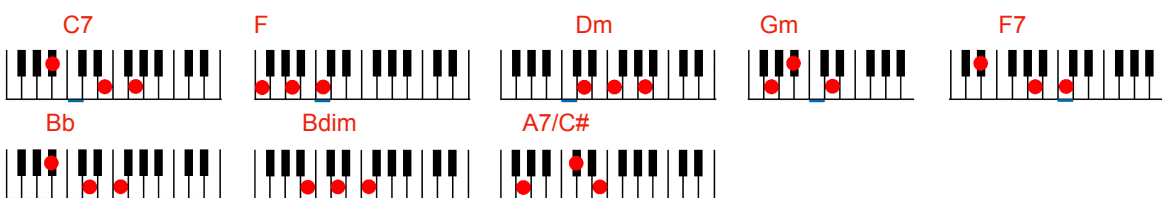
C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char---iot,
 C Am G G7
 coming for to carry me home.
 C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char--iot,
 Am D7 G7 C F C
 coming for to carry me home.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Amazing Grace)



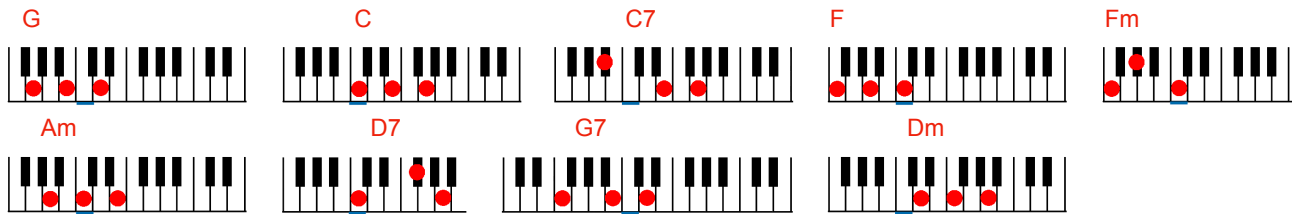
C C7 F C
 Amazing Grace! how sweet the sound,
 C7 G G7
 That saved a wretch like me!
 C C7 F C
 I once was lost, but now am found,
 Am G F - - C
 Was blind, but now I see.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Auld Lang Syne) *Extra Chord 'Gm'



(C7) F Dm Gm C7
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 F F7 Bb Bdim
 And never brought to mind?
 F Dm Gm C7
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 A7/C# Dm Gm C7 F
 And the days of auld lang syne?

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Oh Danny Boy) **NEW CHORD F minor*



(G) C C7 F Fm/Ab

Oh Danny Boy, the pipes, the pipes are calling.

C Am D7 G7

From glen to glen and down the mountainside.

C C7 F Fm/Ab

The summer's gone and all the roses falling.

C Am Dm G7 C F/C C

It's you, It's you must go and I must bide

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Carrickfergus)



(C) Dm G C Am

I wish I was, in Carrickfergus.

Dm G C

Only for nights, in Ballygrand.

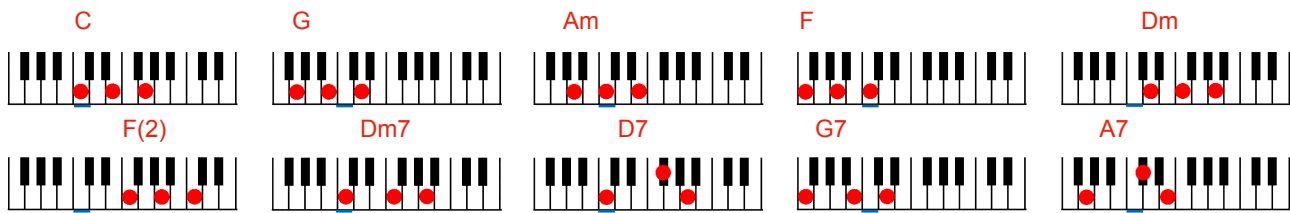
Dm G C Am

I would swim over the deepest ocean,

Dm G C

The deepest ocean to be by your side.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Abide With Me)



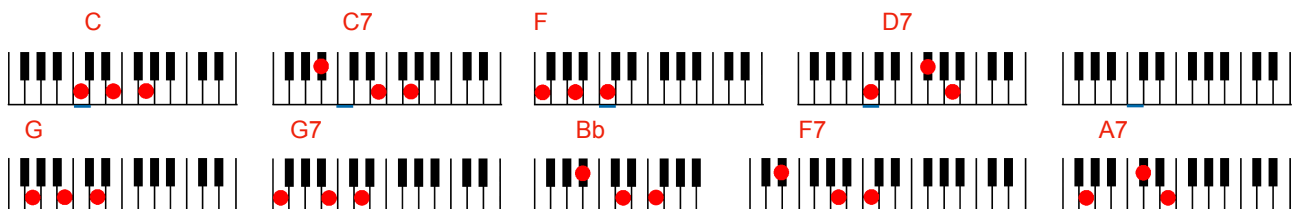
C G/B Am C/G F G C
A—bide with me; fast, falls the even—tide,

C Dm F(2) C/E Dm7 D7 G G7
The dark-ness de---epens; Lord, with me a---bide.

C G/B Am C/G F(2) A7/E Dm Dm/C
When other hel—pers fail and comforts flee,

G G/B C G/B Am Dm C G7 C
Help of the he---lp----less, a-----bide with me.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (In The Blue Ridge Mountains Of Virginia)



C C7 F D7 G7 C7 F
In, The, Blue Ridge Mountains of Virginia, On the trail of the lonesome pine.

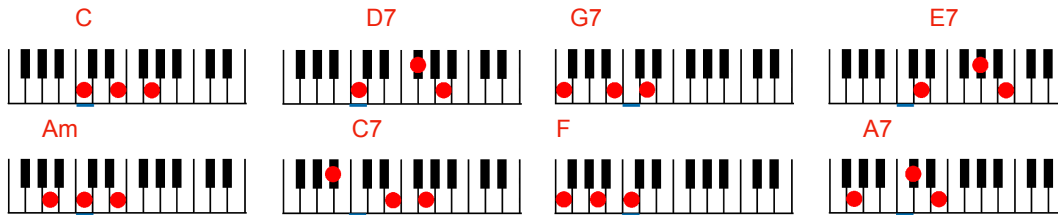
F D7 G
In the pale moon shine, Our hearts entwine.

G7 C7 G7 C7
Where she carved her name, And I carved mine.

F F7 Bb A7
Oh, June, Like the mountains I'm blue, Like the pine, I am lonesome for you.

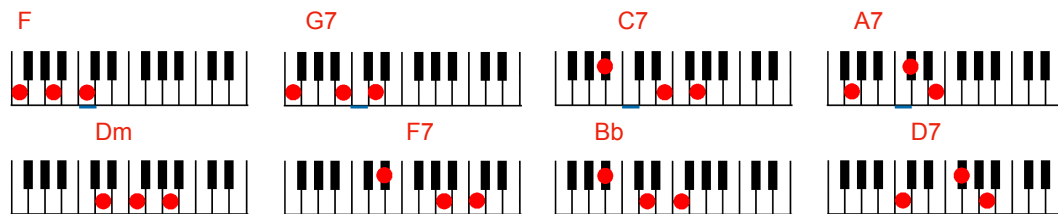
C C7 F D7 G7 C7 F Bb F
In, The, Blue Ridge Mountains of Virginia, On the trail of the lonesome pine.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Aura Lee / Love Me Tender)



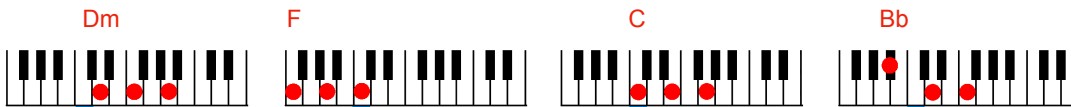
C D7 G7 C
 As the blackbird in the spring, 'neath the willow tree,
 C D7 G7 C
 Sat and piped, I heard him sing; sing of Aura Lee.
 C E7 Am C7 F C
 Aura Lee, Aura Lee, maid with golden hair.
 C A7 D7 G7 C
 Sunshine came along with thee, and swallows in the air.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Aura Lee / Love Me Tender)



F G7 C7 F
 As the blackbird in the spring, 'neath the willow tree,
 F G7 C7 F
 Sat and piped, I heard him sing; sing of Aura Lee.
 F A7 Dm F7 Bb F
 Aura Lee, Aura Lee, maid with golden hair.
 F D7 G7 C7 F
 Sunshine came along with thee, and swallows in the air.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (The Parting Glass) in Dm



Dm F C
 Of all the money that ere I had,
 Dm F C
 I spent it in good com--pany.
 Dm F C
 And all the harm that ere I did,
 Dm C Bb Dm
 Alas! T'was done to none but me.

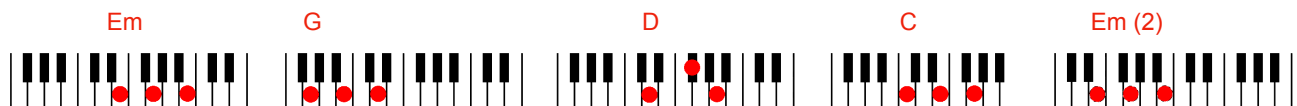
[Bridge]

C F Bb F
 And all I've done for want of wit,
 Gm Bb C
 To memory now I can't recall.

[Chorus]

Dm F C
 So fill to me the parting glass,
 Dm C Bb Dm
 Goodnight and joy be with you all.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (The Parting Glass) in Em



Em G D
 Of all the money that ere I had,
 Em G D
 I spent it in good com--pany.
 Em G D
 And all the harm that ere I did,
 Em D C Em (2)
 Alas! T'was done to none but me.

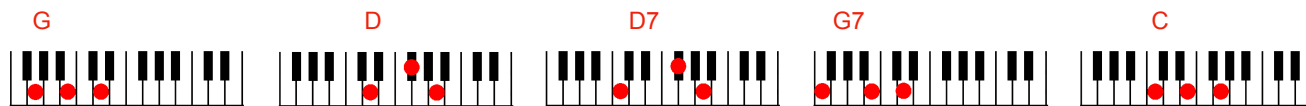
[Bridge]

D G C G
 And all I've done for want of wit,
 Am C D
 To memory now I can't recall.

[Chorus]

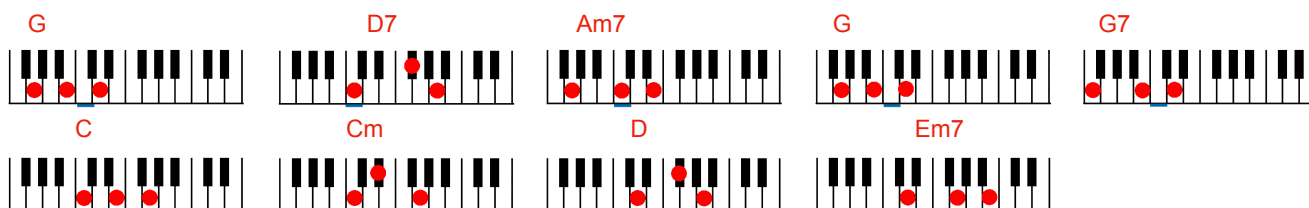
Em G D
 So fill to me the parting glass,
 Em D C Em (2)
 Goodnight and joy be with you all.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Happy Birthday) in G



G D
 Happy Birth----day to you.
 D7 G
 Happy Birth---day to you.
 G G7 C
 Happy Birth----day dear
 G D7 G
 Happy Birth--day to you.

RHYTHM: Static Broken Chord (Happy Birthday) in G with more chords **New Chord 'Cm'*



G D7
 Happy Birth----day to you.
 Am7 D7 G
 Happy Birth----day to you.
 G G7 C (Cm)
 Happy Birth---day dear
 D/B Em7 Am7 D7 G
 Happy Birth---day to you.

STATIC BROKEN CHORD PLUS 1-5-1

You can embellish this rhythm even further by adding more movement in the left hand.

So instead of playing a single note in the left hand when you play the right hand chord you can use the 1-5-1 pattern that you have been using in the 'Melodic Interludes'.

Let's try it with 4 bars of 'Swing Low Sweet Chariot'.

C C7 F C
Swing low, sweet char----iot

STATIC BROKEN CHORD RHYTHM
(Improvise with the chord notes)

ADD the 1-5-1 Left Hand pattern

Go over the practice songs for the Static Broken Chord Rhythm again and add in the 1-5-1 left hand pattern.

Have FUN! :-)

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6



Improvising with the 1-5-123 Ballad

Part 1 C major

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad ¹⁻²⁷⁸

Lets look again at Melodic Interlude number 2 - The 1-5-123 Ballad.

C

Left Hand Right Hand

Fingering 5 2 1 1 2

PLAY TWICE

Move the whole pattern down two notes for Am

Am

PLAY TWICE

Then two notes left again to F

F

PLAY TWICE

Then one note right to G

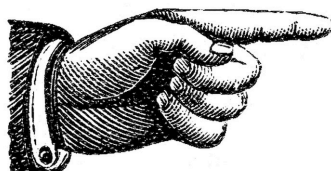
G

PLAY TWICE



Keep the sustain pedal down over each chord change.

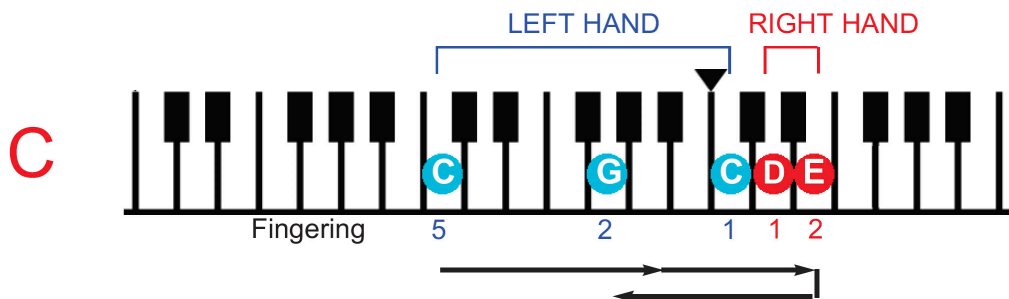
Rather than just running up the notes and back down again,
you are going to play about with the top 4 notes.



MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad

1-279

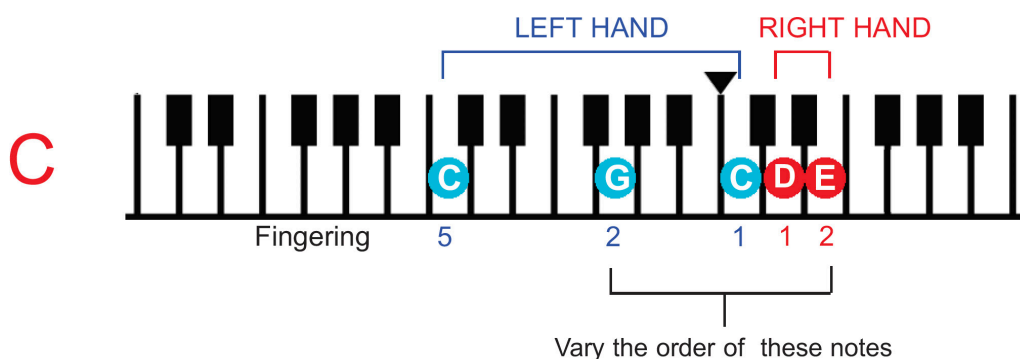
Earlier you played the pattern in a very structured way starting from the bottom note all the way to the top and back down again.



Play the sequence repeatedly but now and then experiment with the order in which you play the 4 higher notes (G - C - D - E).

Imagine you are tapping out a variety of gentle rhythms on a set of Bongos. If you want to - practice by tapping your fingers on the table.

Make sure your variations all fit into the underlying four beats (or 8 HALF beats) per bar.



Keep the sustain pedal down while you improvise.



Now you can apply this rhythmic variation to all 4 chords.

C C Am Am F F G G

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad

1-280

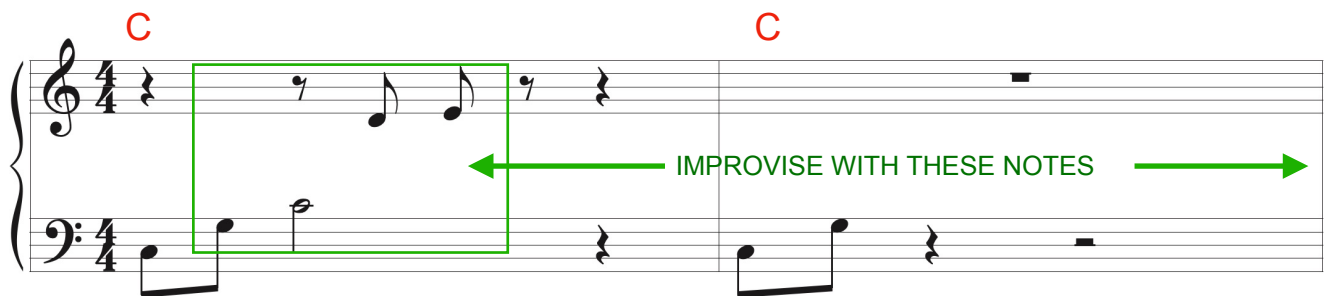
So - you play each chord over TWO bars.

In order to IMPROVISE you run up the 1-5-123 in the first half of the first bar and then improvise over the top 4 notes for the remainder the first bar and the whole of the second bar. Just make sure you play 4 beats per bar or 8 half beats.

You can also play the first two notes of the left hand in the second bar.

Keep the sustain pedal down over each chord change.

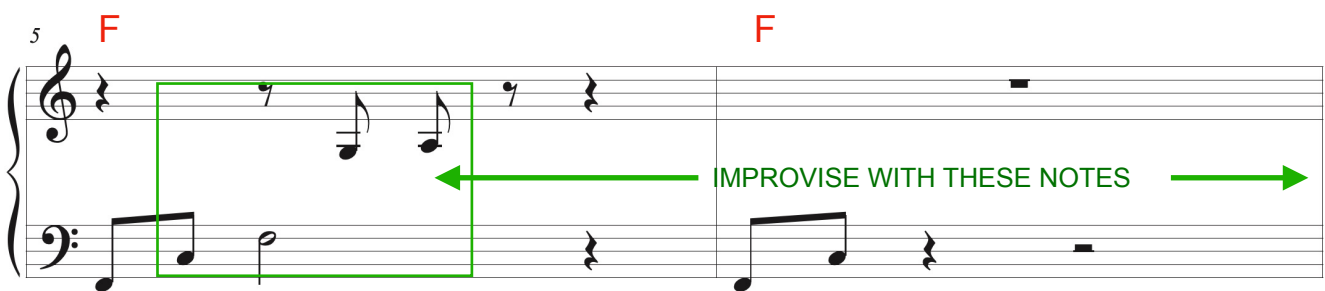
C



Am



F



G



Repeat from bar 1 or end with 2 more bars of C.

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6



Improvising with the 1-5-1²³ Ballad

Part 2 D minor

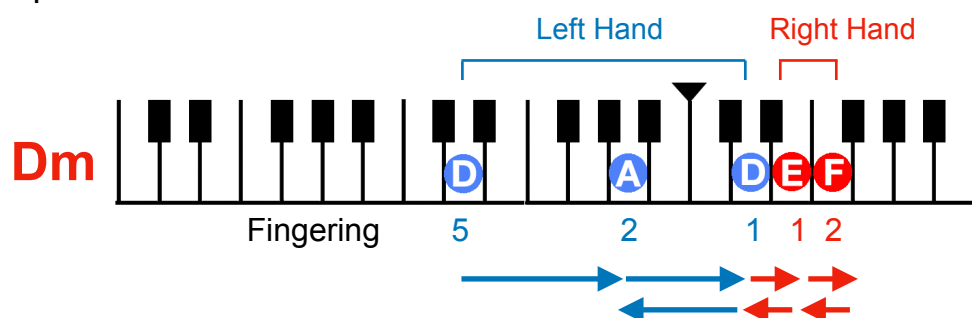
MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad ¹⁻²⁸²

Part 2 - D minor

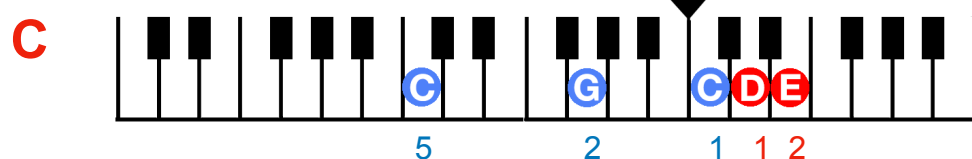
We can APPLY the same patterns to a different chord progression in the key of Dm.

The chords for the progression are Dm, C and Bb.

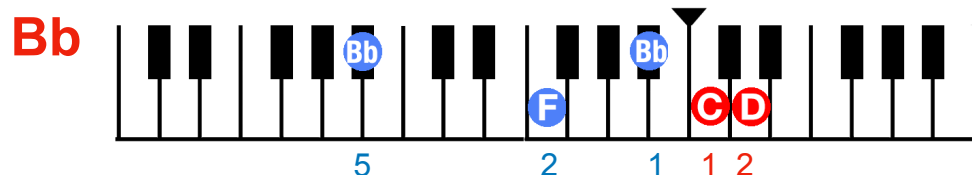
First try the ORIGINAL ascending descending pattern using the three chords.
DON'T improvise.



Move the whole pattern down one white key to C



Then two keys left to Bb



Now APPLY the patterns to the chord progression below.

Dm	Dm	C	C	Dm	Dm
Bb	C	Bb	C	Dm	Dm

Play it first with the original pattern (don't improvise).

Then try it again but improvise with the top 4 notes.

You can follow the videos or the sheet music on the next two pages.

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad ¹⁻²⁸³

D minor (no improvisation)

Pedal over each chord change

The musical score is written in 4/4 time and consists of 12 measures. It is divided into six systems, each containing two measures. The key signature is D minor, indicated by two flats (Bb and F). The tempo/style is 'Ballad'. The score includes a 'Pedal over each chord change' instruction. The chords and their corresponding notes are as follows:

- Measure 1: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)
- Measure 2: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)
- Measure 3: C (C, G, C, D, E, D, C, G)
- Measure 4: C (C, G, C, D, E, D, C, G)
- Measure 5: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)
- Measure 6: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)
- Measure 7: Bb (Bb, F, Bb, C, D, C, Bb, F)
- Measure 8: C (C, G, C, D, E, D, C, G)
- Measure 9: Bb (Bb, F, Bb, C, D, C, Bb, F)
- Measure 10: C (C, G, C, D, E, D, C, G)
- Measure 11: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)
- Measure 12: Dm (D, A, D, E, F, E, D, A)

MELODIC INTERLUDE #6 - Improvising 1-5-123 Ballad 1-284

D minor (Improvise with top 4 notes)

Pedal over each chord change

Dm

Dm

IMPROVISE WITH THESE NOTES

C

C

IMPROVISE WITH THESE NOTES

Dm

Dm

IMPROVISE WITH THESE NOTES

Bb

IMPROVISE

C

IMPROVISE

C

IMPROVISE

Bb

IMPROVISE

C

IMPROVISE

C

IMPROVISE

Dm

Dm

IMPROVISE WITH THESE NOTES

RHYTHM # 11

3 BEAT BOUNCE



3 BEAT BOUNCE RHYTHM

This rhythm is used for songs that are written in 3/4 time (3 beats per bar).

The RIGHT hand plays a steady 3 beats per bar.

Think of a Waltz - "one, two, three, one, two, three..."

The LEFT hand is played on the FIRST beat of EACH bar (OR chord change) AND on a 'half beat' which is played AFTER every 2nd and 3rd beats.

Try it with the chord of C - KEEP REPEATING until you get it.

1 (and) 2 and 3 and 1 (and) 2 and 3 and

C C C C C C



Pedal over each bar or chord change

You can also play it with a 'lighter' feel by just using the thumb of the right hand for beats 2 and 3.

I call the the '3 BEAT BOUNCE LIGHT'.

1 (and) 2 and 3 and 1 (and) 2 and 3 and

C C C C C C

Now try both versions with this 3 BEAT BOUNCE SLASH CHORD progression.

C	C/B	C/A	C/G	Repeat
---	-----	-----	-----	--------

3 BEAT BOUNCE RHYTHM #2

SLOW SONG VERSION

We can also play a variation of the 3 Beat Bounce Rhythm that is more suitable for slow songs. The only change is that you leave out the second beat in the left hand.

Let's look at how the two versions compare.

3 BEAT BOUNCE #1 (and you can play a 'light' version)

3 BEAT BOUNCE #2 (for slower songs)

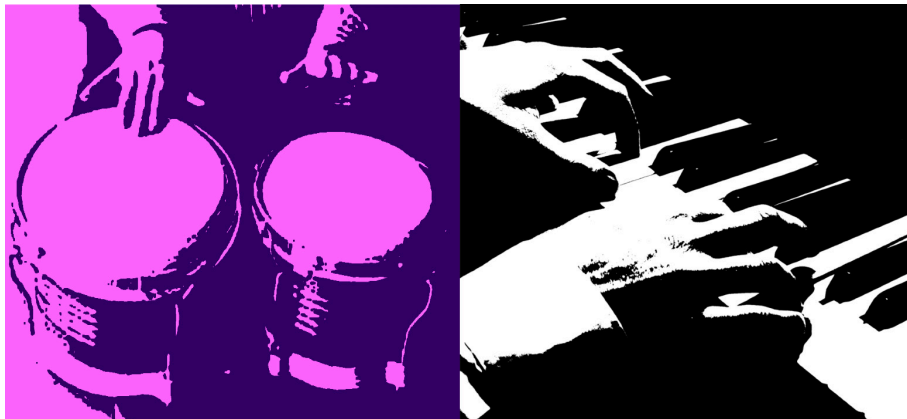
Let's try 3 Beat Bounce Rhythm #2 with Amazing Grace

F F7 Bb F
 Amazing Grace! how sweet the sound,
 F7 C C7
 That saved a wretch like me!
 F F7 Bb F
 I once was lost, but now am found,
 Dm C Bb - - F
 Was blind, but now I see.

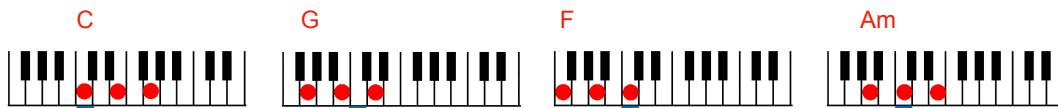
3 BEAT BOUNCE

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS / D, E, A, Bb



RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce 'Light' (Plaisir d'Amour / Can't Help Falling In Love)



C G C
 The joys of love,
 F C G
 Are but a moment long.
 F G Am F
 The pain of love endures,
 C G C
 A whole life long.

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce #2 (Silent Night)



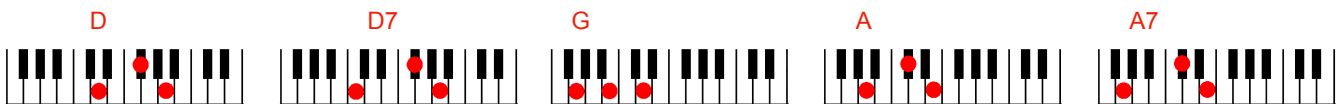
G D D7 G G7
 Silent night! Holy night! All is calm all is bright,
 C G C G
 Round yon virgin mother and child. Holy infant so tender and mild.
 D D7 G Em G D G
 Sleep in heavenly peace! Sleep in heavenly peace!

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce #2 (Amazing Grace) in C



C C7 F C
 Amazing Grace! how sweet the sound,
 C7 G G7
 That saved a wretch like me!
 C C7 F C
 I once was lost, but now am found,
 Am G F - - C
 Was blind, but now I see.

In D



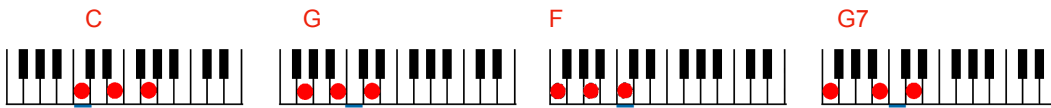
D D7 G D
 Amazing Grace! how sweet the sound,
 D7 A A7
 That saved a wretch like me!
 D D7 G D
 I once was lost, but now am found,
 D/B A G - - D
 Was blind, but now I see.

In G



G G7 C G
 Amazing Grace! how sweet the sound,
 G7 D D7
 That saved a wretch like me!
 G G7 C G
 I once was lost, but now am found,
 Em D C - - G
 Was blind, but now I see.

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (Jock Stewart - Scottish Traditional)



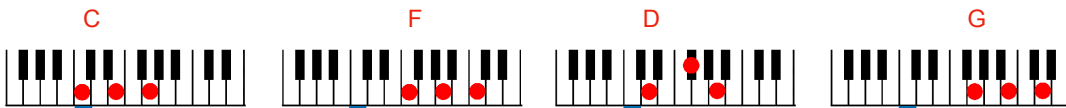
C G C F
 Oh my name is Jock Stewart, I'm a canny young man,
 C G C G
 and a roving young fellow I've been.

C G C F
 So be easy and free when you're drinking with me,
 C G C
 I'm a man you don't meet every day.

C G C F
 I have acres of land, I have ships I command,
 C G C G
 and there's always a shilling to be spared.

C G C F
 So be easy and free when you're drinking with me,
 C G7 C
 I'm a man you don't meet every day.

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (with Slash Chords) (In the style of... Piano Man - Billy Joel)



C	C/B	C/A	C/G	F	C/E	D	G
C	C/B	C/A	C/G	F	F/G	C	C

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (with Slash Chords) (In the style of... Mr Bojangles - Neil Diamond)



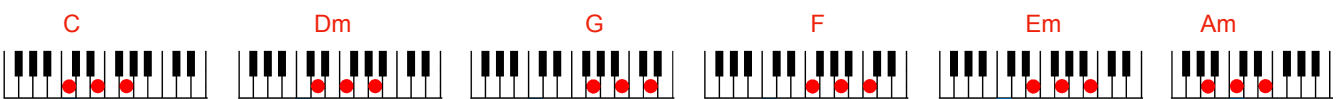
D	D/C#	D/B	D/A	G	G	A	A7
---	------	-----	-----	---	---	---	----

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... Only Love Can Break Your Heart - Neil)



F	Bb	C	C7	F	Bb	C	C7
---	----	---	----	---	----	---	----

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... Morning Has Broken - Cat Stevens)



C	C	Dm	G	F	C	C	Em	Am	G	G
---	---	----	---	---	---	---	----	----	---	---

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... Try To Remember the kind of September... - Tom Jones)



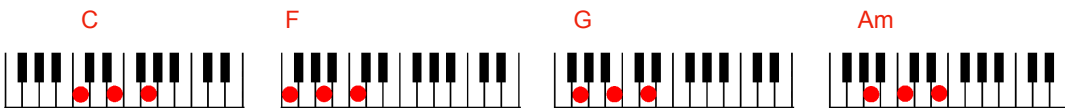
G	Em	Am	D7	Repeat
---	----	----	----	--------

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... Edelweiss - Sound of Music)



G	D	G	C	G	Em	Am7	D7
---	---	---	---	---	----	-----	----

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... All I Want - Kodaline)



Verses

(/ = Repeat measure)

C	/	F	C	/	/	/	C	/	G/B	Am	/	/	/
F	/	/	C	/	/	/	F	/	/	C			

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... Sweet Baby James - James Taylor)



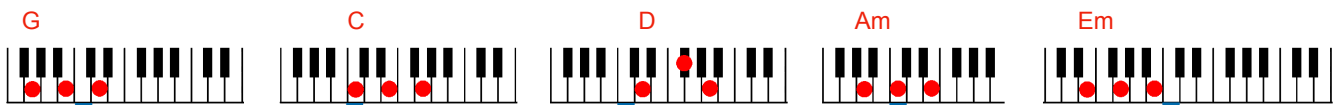
C	G	F	Em	Am	F	C	Em
Am	F	C	Em	F	C	G	Dm7

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... The Times They Are A-Changin' - Bob Dylan)



G	Em	C	G	G	G	Am	C	D
G	Em	C	G	G	G	Am	D	D
D	D/C	D/B	D/A	G	G	D	D	G

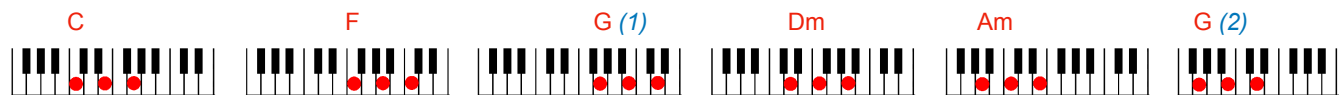
RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... And The Band Played Waltzing Matilda - *CHORUS*) in G



Chorus

G	C	G	G	G	C	D	D
C	Am	G	Em	G	D	G	G

RHYTHM: 3 Beat Bounce (In the style of... And The Band Played Waltzing Matilda - *CHORUS*) in C



Chorus

C	F	C	C	C	F	G (1)	G (1)
F	Dm	C	Am	C	G (2)	C	C

RHYTHM: 3BB (In the style of... Annie's Song - *John Denver*)



You fill up my..

C	C	F	G	Am	F	C	C/B	C/A
C/G	F	Em	Dm	F	G	F/G	G	

MELODIC INTERLUDE #7



3/4 time 1-5-123

Silent Night

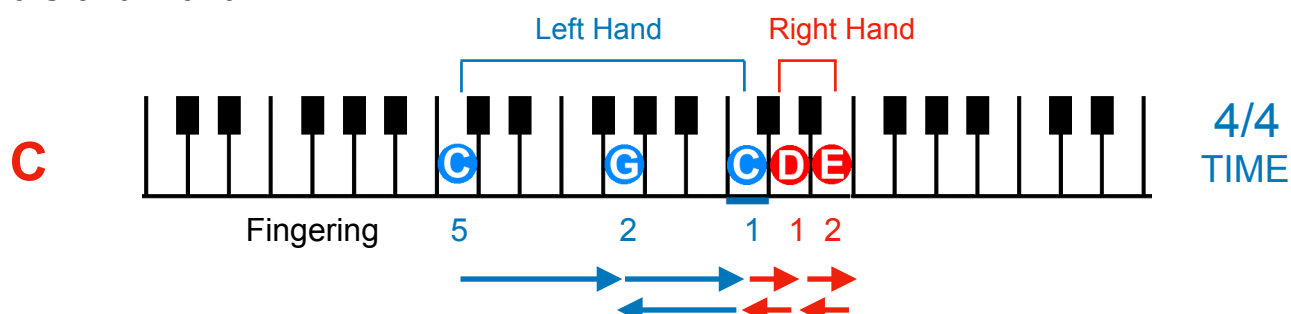
Plaisir d'Amour

MELODIC INTERLUDE #7 - 3/4 time 1-5-123

SILENT NIGHT

1-296

Up to now you have been playing the 1-5-123 pattern in 4/4 time (4 beats to the bar) so when you run up and down the pattern you have counted "1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and".

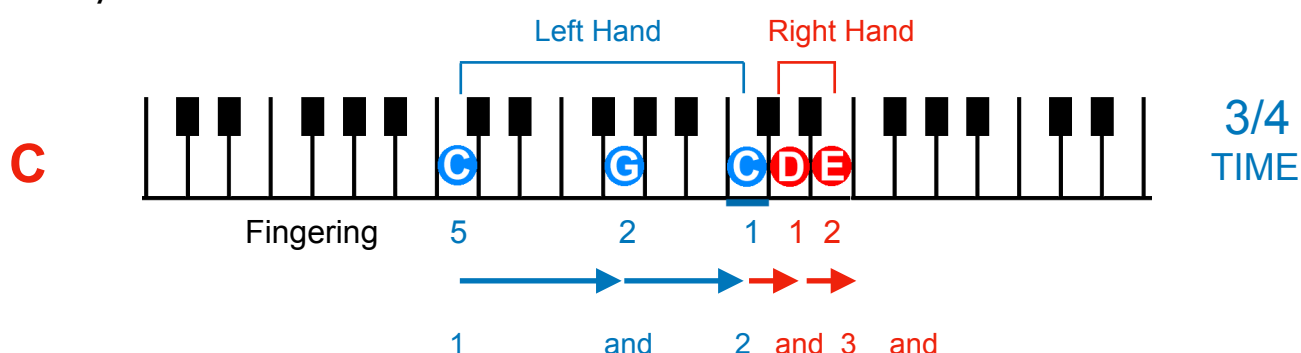


You can also play the notes of the pattern in 3/4 time (3 beats to the bar).

This time you don't run up and down the pattern - you ONLY run UP the notes.

And you count "1 and 2 and 3 and" (the last note 'E' is held for the "3 and").

Let's try it with the C chord.



This is the pattern repeated over 2 bars.



MELODIC INTERLUDE #7 - 3/4 time 1-5-1²³

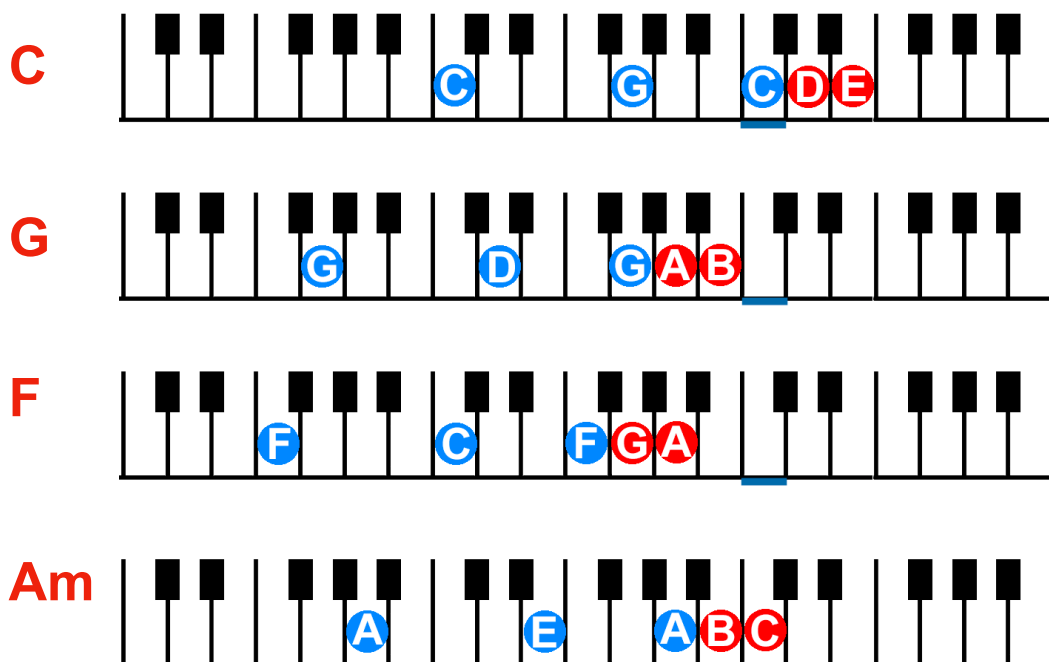
1-297

SILENT NIGHT

Now you can APPLY this pattern to chord progressions in 3/4 time.
Like the beautiful song 'SILENT NIGHT'.

C	C	C	C	G	G7	C	C7
Silent night! Holy night! All is calm, all is bright,							
F	F	C		C	F	F	C
Round yon virgin mother and child, Holy infant so tender and mild,							
G	G7	C	Am	C	G	C	(C)
Sleep in heavenly peace! Sleep in heavenly peace!							

The LOCATION of the notes for each chord



Watch the video carefully to see how you can add the 7th notes

MELODIC INTERLUDE #7 - 3/4 time 1-5-1²³

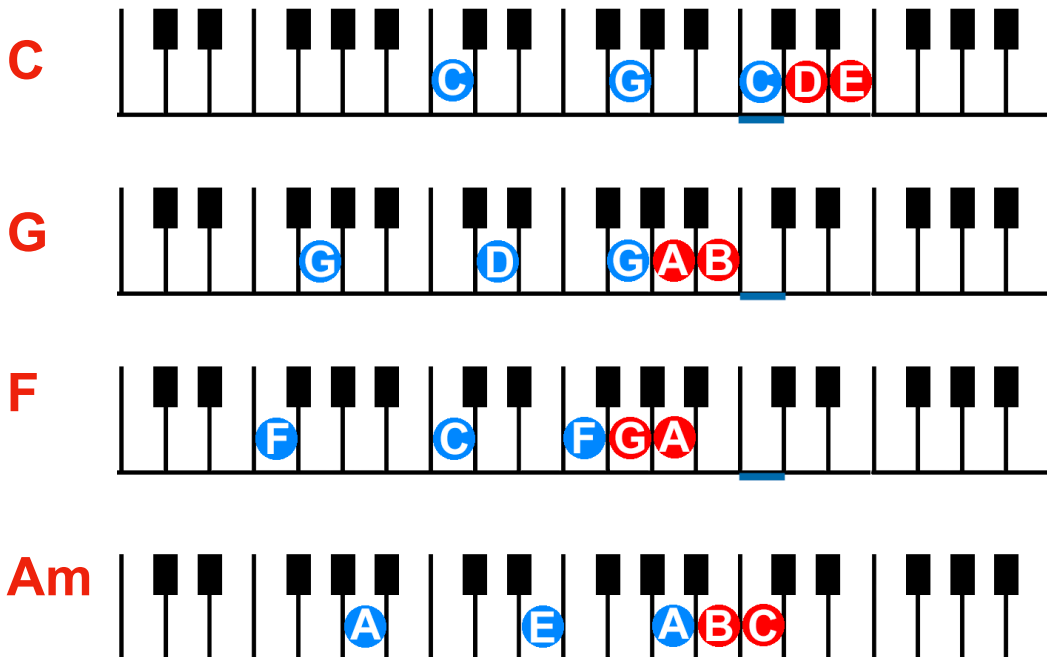
1-298

PLAISIR D'AMOUR

You can also APPLY this pattern to the song 'Plaisir d'Amour' - which has nearly the same melody as 'Can't Help Falling In Love' (Elvis).

	C		G		C	
The	joys		of		love	
	F		C		G	
Are	but	a	moment	long.		
	F		G		Am	
The	pain		of		love	endures
	C		G		C	
A	whole		life		long.	

The LOCATION of the notes for each chord.





LESSONS CHECKPOINT



1-299

- ☐ Do you understand how to play the TWIST rhythm? Record yourself playing the rhythm to make sure it sounds the same as I play it.
- ☐ What notes do you use in both hands for the Twist Rhythm?
- ☐ Do you understand the concept of 'Slash' chords? If you see C/B what does that indicate? What are slash chords used for?
- ☐ Did you understand the 'Static Broken Chord' rhythm? Were you able to apply it to the practice progressions?
- ☐ What is the main characteristic of the Static Broken Chord rhythm?
- ☐ Did you try improvising with the 1-5-123 Ballad in C major and in D minor?
- ☐ What notes of the 1-5-123 pattern do you use for improvisation? What notes remain constant in every bar?
- ☐ Did you experiment with the right hand improvisation - from just a few notes to lots of notes?
- ☐ Did you understand the 3 BEAT BOUNCE rhythms? How many beats are there in each bar for the 3 Beat Bounce?
- ☐ Can you play it from memory using the chord of C? Could you tap out the rhythm with both hands on a table top?

The next rhythm - Bossa Nova Bounce - is probably the hardest rhythm so far. Don't panic - everyone struggles with it until it 'clicks'.

As you will see from the number of practice progressions, the Bossa Nova Bounce is used in more songs than any other rhythm - so stick with it - it's ESSENTIAL that you learn it!

YOU ARE NOW READY
FOR

Book 1

RHYTHM
STYLE



Part 6